CONNOR SPEARS

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SUMMARY

Indie game developer with 5+ years of experience in **Systems Design**, **Tools Programming**, and **Project Management**. Extensive knowledge of the game development pipeline, from pre-production **rapid prototyping**, to full-scale production and shipping on platforms such as **Steam**. Worked on teams of various sizes, from as small as 3 to as large as 50, as well as a multitude of solo projects. Interested in helping teams to create great games, either through handy tools, or a **Kanban** board.

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Unity, Unreal, C#, C++, Notion, Figma, Obsidian, Atlassian Suite, Git, Blender
Design Skills: Systems, Level, Puzzle, Progression Systems, Accessibility, UI, Economy Management, Rapid Prototyping, Macro Charts, Vertical Slices, Gameplay Balancing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Certified Instructor — Remote, NJ
GameU — Mar 2025 - Present

- Assisted students to find their passion in game development through various art programs, Minecraft modding, Roblox, Unity, web development, and Construct 3
- Work with students one-on-one to create games from prototyping to publishing
- Prepare under privileged children for a career in technology
- Problem-solve issues that arise when dealing with special needs individuals

Lead Designer and UI/UX Programmer — Ann Arbor, MI
WolverineSoft Studios — Aug 2023 - Apr 2025

- Participated on a large team of ~40, used tools such as **Git**, **Jira**, **Confluence**, and **Figma** to create games in Unity
- Created an online strategy game called Tails of War which taught **Photon** and how to ask leadership for advice
- Led an R&D team of three where we developed a prototype for a 2D hex-map city builder, taught **systems programming**, **documentation writing**, and **Rapid Prototyping**
- Continued development of our R&D project serving as **Lead Designer** using tools like **Notion** to write documentation on multiple systems including dialogue, random events, gear, and buildings

UNIVERSITY PROJECTS

Project Promotion — Jan 2025 - Dec 2025

- Led a team of undergrads through preproduction and a semester of full production on a 2.5D Tactical RPG
- Assigned tasks and wrote documentation on subjects such as **Design Pillars**, **Keystones**, and **Personas**
- Developed core gameplay systems such as **A* Navigation**, a **Conditional Turn Battle System**, and a **State Machine**
- Designed and presented a **Pitch Deck** to to evaluate potential for full scale production in the following course

Cat-astrophe — Jan 2023 - Apr 2023

- Solo-developed a 3D puzzle-action platformer as part of an independent study
- Designed a responsive and smooth player controller as well as dozens of different interactable objects
- Conducted playtesting and iteration, resulting in an eighth out of ~30 finish at the UM-EMU games showcase

EDUCATION

Masters of Arts in Media and Information — East Lansing, MI
Michigan State University — Jul 2026

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Cum Laude — Ypsilanti, MI
Minor in Simulation, Animation, and Gaming — Dec 2024
Eastern Michigan University